PITCHSIDE CARD

THE COACHING INTERACTION MENU

Twelve ways to respond once you've decided to step in, from saying nothing to a direct command. None of them is the default: the one that fits depends on the player and the moment.

1 OBSERVE

Deliberately gather information before you decide to act.

Says nothing yet. Watch first.

2 SILENCE

Deliberately withhold input so the player has to solve it themselves.

Says nothing. The learning is in the solving.

3 QUESTION

Ask an open question that makes them think for themselves.

"What else could you have done there?"

Works well with: Freeze frame, Huddle, Drinks break, Pull aside

4 GUIDE AND DISCOVERY

Steer with a nudge and let them find the answer themselves.

"Who was free?"

Works well with: In-flow, Pull aside, Freeze frame

5 CO-CREATE

Build the solution with the players rather than handing it over.

"What do we want to try in the next three minutes?"

Works well with: Huddle, Drinks break

6 CHECK UNDERSTANDING

Ask the player to tell you back what they have taken from it.

"Tell me what you're looking for before the ball arrives."

Works well with: Huddle, Walkthrough, Drinks break

7 DEMONSTRATE

Show the action rather than describe it.

"Watch where my eyes go before the ball gets to me."

Works well with: Walkthrough, Freeze frame, Huddle

8 REFRAME

Change how the player sees the moment, not what they do.

"That wasn't a bad pass — that was the right idea a second late."

Works well with: In-flow, Pull aside, Drinks break, Huddle

9 FEEDBACK

Tell the player what happened and what it caused.

"Your first touch went toward the defender, so they got to it first."

Works well with: In-flow, Pull aside, Drinks break

10 REINFORCE

Name what was good, precisely, so it happens again.

"That's it — you looked before it came to you."

Works well with: In-flow, Pull aside

11 CHALLENGE

Raise the demand on a player who is comfortable.

"Can you do that again with your other foot?"

Works well with: In-flow, Pull aside, Drinks break

12 INSTRUCT

Give a direct, unambiguous command.

"Body between the ball and the defender. Now."

Works well with: Freeze frame, Huddle, Walkthrough, In-flow

The "works well with" pairings refer to the six ways to stop play (in-flow, drinks break, pull aside, freeze frame, huddle, walkthrough). They're suggestions, not rules. More at usepitchlabs.com/learn.